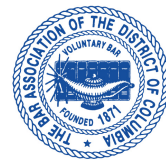


# When recruiting outpaces the curriculum, legal education suffers.

*A resolution on accelerated law-firm recruiting.*



## WHAT WE ASK YOU TO ADOPT

A resolution urging law schools, private legal employers, bar associations, and other stakeholders to:

1. **Study** how accelerating recruitment timelines affect legal education, student well-being, and the entry-level hiring market; and
2. **Consider**, in their own recruitment practices and policies, the educational, professional, and equitable interests of law students.

# 85%

of 2L summer offers now made before July of the 1L year — up from 34% just one cycle earlier

# 18

law-school student governments asked the ABA to act

## WHY IT MATTERS

- **For decades this happened in August, after 1L ended.** The decision now lands inside the first year — some outreach begins about six weeks in.
- **Students commit before they're ready** — before first grades, before legal writing is finished, before any clinic or elective.
- **75% tie rising anxiety directly to recruiting pressure**, and a majority of surveyed Class of 2028 students say the timeline hurt them.
- **Only 25% knew these timelines before enrolling** — a compressed calendar rewards students who already have networks.
- **Employers lose too** — they hire on less information, and no single firm can slow down alone.

## Resolution 403 is the first step out.

**The students asked first.** On January 1, 2026, student governments at 18 law schools (Columbia, Cornell, Duke, Georgetown, Harvard, Michigan, Northwestern, NYU, Penn, Stanford, Texas, UC Berkeley, UCLA, Chicago, Virginia, Vanderbilt, WashU, and Yale) jointly asked the ABA to review accelerating recruitment, several backed by student polls showing supermajority support. **Sponsored by the Bar Association of the District of Columbia, with a coalition of law schools.** Approved by the BADC Board of Directors and recommended by its Young Lawyers Section; the drafters are aware of no opposition.



## Please vote to ADOPT Resolution 403.

Scan for the full resolution, the report, the data, the coalition, and sources, at [legal-recruiting-timeline-initiative.github.io/law-student-hiring-resolution](https://legal-recruiting-timeline-initiative.github.io/law-student-hiring-resolution)

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**Sources:** NALP, *Perspectives on 2025 Law Student Recruiting* (Jan. 2026); LSAC & NALP, *2025 1L Class: Student Awareness and Impact of Accelerated Big Law Recruitment* (June 2026); Law.com (June 11, 2026); Bloomberg Law (Dec. 11, 2025); ABA Journal (May 14, 2026). Full citations at the site above. Builds on existing ABA policy 23A523 and 24A515.

**AMERICAN BAR ASSOCIATION****BAR ASSOCIATION OF THE DISTRICT OF COLUMBIA****REPORT TO THE HOUSE OF DELEGATES****RESOLUTION**

1 **RESOLVED**, That the American Bar Association urges law schools, private legal  
2 employers, bar associations, and other stakeholders in the legal community to study the  
3 impact of accelerating law firm recruitment timelines on the quality of legal education, the  
4 well-being of law students, and the long-term health of the entry-level legal hiring market;  
5 and

6 **FURTHER RESOLVED**, That the American Bar Association urges law schools, private  
7 legal employers, bar associations, and other stakeholders in the legal community to  
8 consider, in their respective recruitment practices and policies, the educational,  
9 professional, and equitable interests of law students, including their need for adequate  
10 time to develop the analytical, ethical, and professional competencies that the first year  
11 of legal education is designed to foster.